We do not therefore have a satisfactory explanation of knowledge in the dualistic theory of Sānkhya-Yoga, according to which the unconscious Buddhi is suddenly and mechanically illuminated by the Puruṣa. It first of all assumes that the subject and the object of experience are wholly outside experience and then struggles to bring them inside. As Sri Radhakrishnan says: "If the passive consciousness of the Puruṣa and the incessant movement of Prakṛti are regarded as independent of each other the problem of philosophy is insoluble."[11] An analysis of experience should be able to tell us that the subject and the object of knowledge are not absolutely separate and that equally both have a fundamental transcendental consciousness as their support within which they unite.

CRITICISM OF THE THEORY OF THE INTERMEDIARY NATURE OF BUDDHI

In Sānkhya-Yoga metaphysics any relationship between consciousness and unconsciousness seems absolutely impossible.

But some recent Indian scholars (Dasgupta and Sinha) have tried to reduce the gulf between the Puruṣa and Prakṛti and to make an interaction of the two possible on the basis of which alone is any supposed reflection to take place. It is obvious that a reflection between two absolutely heterogeneous objects is not possible. Attempts therefore have been made to reduce the antithesis to its minimum by providing for the similarity of the Sattva in its purest state with the nature of the Cit and thus making an interaction possible.

Professor Sinha says, "The dualism of Sānkhya is modified by the admission that there are different grades of existence among the modifications of Prakṛti, the highest of which is Buddhi."[12] The Buddhi is unconscious no doubt, but it is so transparent owing to the predominance of the Sattva that it is not entirely foreign to the nature of the Puruṣa, hence, it can catch the reflection of the Puruṣa, whereas gross material objects cannot reflect the light of the Puruṣa owing to the predominance of Tamas in them. Thus Buddhi is represented as a kind of "intermediary reality between gross matter and conscious Puruṣa,"[13] and is supposed to partake of the nature of both. It is unconscious like gross matter, but it is transparent like self-luminous Puruṣa. It is only in the Buddhi that the conscious Puruṣa and the unconscious material objects come into contact with each other. Thus there is made possible a mutual reflection of the one in the other.